

Ohio River Trail Council Cycling Club

Mahoning Shadow Trail

30.4 Mile Bike Trail Ride

City / State: Fordham, Pennsylvania

County: Jefferson County

Date: Saturday, May 12, 2012

Time: 10:00 am

Surface: Crushed stone, dirt, streets (Punxsutawney)

Meeting Point: [Fordham Trailhead](#) (Google Map)

Surface: Paved asphalt

RSVP: ortctrailride@gmail.com

Come out for a ride! This is part of a trail ride series sponsored by the Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) and the Western Pennsylvania Wheelman intended to bring awareness to the wonderful trails in our 4-state region (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia).

All riders are welcome for this free, rails-to-trails, moderate-paced ride!

The Mahoning Shadow Trail (MST) is a rails to trail project that runs generally east-west in southern Jefferson County. The Trail is 15.2 miles long with it's western terminus in Fordham-Nalier, PA area, and it's eastern terminus on the Winslow Road east of Punxsutawney, PA. Most of the length of the MST runs along the Mahoning Creek with the exception of the three eastern end miles that branches off the Mahoning Creek Valley.

For this ride...

The ORTC Cycling Club will begin in the village of Fordham, the western trailhead of the Mahoning Shadow Trail. The ride is flat, mostly crushed stone trail along the scenic Mahoning Creek to the famous town of Punxsutawney, continuing on to the village of Cloe. Amongst other remnants, along the way are numerous coke ovens from the region's industrial heritage.

From Cloe, the 30 mile ride continues as a moderate climb through the scenic highlands mixed hemlock forest until "Devil's Elbow" Road near the village of Hudson, where the trail ends. The extended portion of the ride enjoys scenic vistas and a waterfall. The ride then returns to Punxsutawney for lunch. In Punxsutawney riders may opt to spend some post-lunch free-time (about an hour) to check out the town before returning the final seven miles to Fordham.

[Mahoning Shadow Trail Map](#) from Valier to Indiana Street and from the Skate Park to Winslow.

Features of Interest:

The Mahoning Shadow Trail uses the old rail bed of the Pennsylvania and Northwestern Railroad (P&NW) that originated in Bellwood area near Altoona and terminated at Fordham.

By 1890 the rails were finished to the Fordham terminus, and the primary function of the P&NW was to service the growing coal industry in southern Jefferson County. The tracks west of Punxsutawney accommodated the Eureka mines of the Berwind-White Coal Company.

The length of the MST is littered with artifacts from the P&NW and various mining operations. As you ride you will notice railroad ties, cut stone, the occasional steel rails and plates, side tracks, junctions, and mining spoils.

Of particular note is the 50 beehive coke ovens that used the local mined coal to create coke for the steel industry.

Don't forget your camera!

Lunch:

We will meet for lunch after the ride.

Weather:

The weather forecast is mostly sunny and 71 degrees. Stay tuned for weather cancellations. Cancellations will be posted by 9 pm Friday (for Saturday Rides) or 9 pm Saturday (for Sunday Rides). Rides that are cancelled due to inclement weather are usually rescheduled for the next day for Saturday rides and the following week for Sunday rides.

Trailhead Address and Directions:

Generally, take PA-28 North from Pittsburgh to PA-210N towards Fordham. Pa.

Fordham Rd./CR 3015 (Valier)

[Fordham Trailhead Map](#)

[Fordham Trailhead Photo #1](#)

Drive time from Pittsburgh: 1 hour 30 min.
Drive time from Monaca: 2 hours

GPS: 40.91359,-79.038595

Carpooling:



We are glad to facilitate carpooling as well. Just contact Nathan Peluso at npeluso@hotmail.com. Carpooling meeting locations are either Pittsburgh, Cranberry Twp., Robinson Twp., or Beaver, Pa.

Website Links:

<http://www.traillink.com/trail/mahoning-shadow-trail.aspx>
<http://www.punxsutawney.com/trail/>
http://www.orgsites.com/pa/northfork29/_pgg7.php3

Ohio River Trail Council

The Ohio River Trail Council (ORTC) is currently planning & developing a 41-mile bike and water trail, the Ohio River Trail (ORT), along the Ohio River, from Coraopolis, Pa (near Pittsburgh) to Ohioville, Pa. (near East Liverpool, OH). The ORT is part of the *Rivers of Steel National Heritage Area*, *Lewis & Clark Trail* and is a candidate for part of the *U.S. Bicycle Route 50* and a portion of the *Underground Railroad Bicycle Route, Pittsburgh spur*. The proposed ORT will also follow parts of the "*Great Path*" and the *Lincoln Highway*. The ORT will serve as a key segment in the interconnection of existing land trails in the quad-state area (Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia). Specifically, the proposed Ohio River Trail will connect the *Great Ohio Lake-to-River Greenway* in Columbiana County, Ohio to the *Great Allegheny Passage* in Allegheny, County Pennsylvania forming a mega-trail from the great lakes region to our nation's capitol. The ORTC is an organization committed to excellence, with a clear vision and a passion for delivering outstanding results. We ask you to form an alliance with us to capitalize on our strengths in order to guarantee a bright future for our rivers, forests, and towns. Please visit www.ohiorivertrail.org for additional information and a [donation form](#).



Ohio River Trail Cycling Club

The Ohio River Trail Cycling Club is a recreational club that promotes health, wellness and fitness in our community through a variety of biking events. Our goal is to encourage cyclists of all abilities to explore the wonderful opportunities of the region - from the Heritage Trail of Pittsburgh to the rural scenery of the 4-state area, including Maryland, Ohio, Pennsylvania and West Virginia. The club provides cyclists with a diversity of riding experiences. Ohio River Trail Council members can be seen on city bikes, comfort bikes, cyclocross bikes, hybrids, mountain bikes, recumbents, road bikes, touring bikes and tandems.

The ORTC Cycling Club supports and promotes safe bicycle riding. If you have been inactive for several years or are currently under medical care, please consult your doctor before starting a new exercise program. It is highly recommended to always carry water and food. In addition, please bring a spare tube, pump and tools to replace a flat tire. A Consumer Product Safety Commission (CPSC) approved bicycle helmet securely fitted

and fastened is required on all ORTC Trail Series Rides. In order to participate in our events please print and sign the [OHIO RIVER TRAIL COUNCIL CYCLING CLUB RELEASE](#) and mail to ORTC 1100 Pennsylvania Av Monaca, Pa 15061. The ORTC club members serve as ambassadors for bicycling every time we ride thus projecting a positive image of bicycling to the public. Always follow the rules of the road!

About the Trail Ride Series:

- Rails-to-trails related that are 10-50 miles in length.
- Moderate and self-paced rides located within 2 hours drive of Pittsburgh, Pa.
- Meet for lunch or dinner either mid-way or at the end.
- Two - four rides per month on Saturday or Sunday.
- Feel free to forward this email. This publication is intended for widespread distribution.

Example rides include the [Allegheny Highlands Trail](#), [Allegheny River & Samuel Justus Trails](#), [Armstrong Trail](#), [Arrowhead Trail](#), [Bike and Hike Trail](#), [Butler-Freeport Trail](#), [C & O Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Conotton Creek Trail](#), [Deckers Creek Trail](#), [Ghost Town Trail](#), [Greater Wheeling Trail](#), [Hoodlebug Trail](#), [Little Beaver Creek Greenway](#), [Lower Trail](#), [Mahoning Shadow Trail](#), [Maurice K. Goddard State Park Trail](#), [Mill Creek MetroParks Bikeway](#), [Montour Trail](#), [Ohio & Erie Canal Towpath Trail](#), [Oil Creek State Park Trail](#), [Panhandle Trail](#), [Pine Creek Trail](#), [Sandy Creek Trail](#), [Stavich Trail](#), [Steel Valley Trail](#), [Three Rivers Heritage Trail](#), [Western Reserve Greenway Trumbull MetroParks](#), [West Penn Trail](#), and [Youghiogheny River Trail](#).

Please refer to the provisional ORTC Trail Series [Ride Schedule](#) or ORTC [Event Calendar](#) for additional dates and times. Click here to view the [ORTC meeting schedule](#). To join the Ohio River Trail Council and become a member of the ORTC Cycling Club please download a [membership application](#) and mail your contribution to the ORTC office. Feel free to forward this message to a friend. Please visit our [website](#) and [register](#) to receive ORTC correspondence. Thank you for your support.



For questions and comments please contact:

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